SITE INTELLIGENCE

Falconers, Moult Hill, Salcombe — Estate Optimisation

Full site feasibility and development opportunity assessment for Falconers

Housing Needs Assessment

Pre-Planning Application

Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF

Client:
Reference: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-HousingNeeds-R01
Date: 23 March 2026
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Contents

Contents

1 Abbreviations . . . 2
2 How to Read This Report . . . 3
2.1 Reading Order . . . 3
2.2 Report Structure . . . 3
2.3 Traffic-Light Key . . . 3
2.4 What to Do Next . . . 3
3 Introduction . . . 4
4 Policy Context . . . 5
5 Demographic Profile . . . 6
6 Tenure Analysis . . . 7
7 Affordability . . . 8
7.1 Affordability Ratios . . . 8
7.2 Private Rents . . . 8
8 Housing Mix . . . 9
9 Special Needs Housing . . . 10
9.1 Older People . . . 10
9.2 People with Disabilities . . . 10
9.3 Self-Build & Custom Housebuilding . . . 10
10 Conclusions . . . 11
11 Known Limitations and Assumptions . . . 12
11.1 What This Report Does NOT Assess . . . 12
11.2 Data Gaps . . . 12
11.3 Key Assumptions . . . 12
11.4 Specialist Investigation Required . . . 13
11.5 Changes That Would Require Update . . . 13
12 Verification Status Summary . . . 14
13 Data Assurance Summary . . . 15
13.1 Data Coverage . . . 15
13.2 Data Confidence . . . 15
13.3 Quality Assurance Checklist . . . 15
14 Anticipated Consultee Queries . . . 16
15 Update Triggers . . . 17
16 Important: Limitations, Disclaimers and Conditions of Use . . . 18

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1 Abbreviations

No report-specific abbreviations have been defined. Standard abbreviations used throughout Site Intelligence reports are listed below.

Abbreviation	Definition
ALC	Agricultural Land Classification
AOD	Above Ordnance Datum
AQMA	Air Quality Management Area
BGS	British Geological Survey
BMV	Best and Most Versatile (agricultural land)
BNG	Biodiversity Net Gain
CIL	Community Infrastructure Levy
DAS	Design and Access Statement
EA	Environment Agency
EIA	Environmental Impact Assessment
FRA	Flood Risk Assessment
FZ	Flood Zone
HLS	Housing Land Supply
LPA	Local Planning Authority
NPPF	National Planning Policy Framework
PTAL	Public Transport Accessibility Level
SAC	Special Area of Conservation
SPA	Special Protection Area
SSSI	Site of Special Scientific Interest
SuDS	Sustainable Drainage Systems
TPO	Tree Preservation Order

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2 How to Read This Report

This section explains how the report is structured, how risk ratings are presented, and what action you should take based on the findings.

2.1 Reading Order

We recommend the following reading order:

1. Executive Summary — a one-page overview of the key findings and overall risk rating. Start here if you are short on time.
2. Main body sections — detailed analysis of each topic area, presented in a logical sequence from site context through to recommendations.
3. Recommendations — specific actions required before, during, or after the planning process.
4. Limitations and Disclaimers — important caveats on the scope of the assessment and the conditions under which the findings are valid.

2.2 Report Structure

Every section of Housing Needs Assessment follows a consistent structure:

- Context — what the section covers and why it matters to the development proposal.
- Data and Evidence — the factual information drawn from public datasets, enrichment APIs, and client-supplied information.
- Analysis — our professional assessment of what the data means for the site.
- Risk Rating — a traffic-light classification (where applicable) summarising the level of concern.
- Recommendation — what action, if any, is required.

2.3 Traffic-Light Key

Risk ratings throughout this report use a three-colour system:

LOW	Low risk. No significant constraint identified. Standard design measures are sufficient. No specialist investigation is likely to be required.
MEDIUM	Moderate risk. A constraint or data gap has been identified that requires attention. Further investigation, a design response, or a planning condition may be needed.
HIGH	High risk. A significant constraint or issue has been identified. Specialist investigation, a specific design solution, or early engagement with the relevant statutory body is strongly recommended before submission.

2.4 What to Do Next

1. Review the Executive Summary for an overview of all findings.
2. Focus on any items rated AMBER or RED — these require action before or during the planning process.
3. Check the Recommendations section for a prioritised list of next steps.
4. Review the Update Triggers section to understand when this report should be refreshed.
5. Contact Site Intelligence if you have questions about any finding or wish to commission follow-up specialist work.

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3 Introduction

This Housing Needs Assessment has been prepared by Site Intelligence (a service of PF & Co Holdings Ltd) on behalf of in support of a planning application for the proposed development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF.

The assessment analyses local housing need using demographic data, tenure profiles, and affordability indicators to demonstrate that the proposed housing mix responds to identified needs in the South Hams District Council area.

Site Address	Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF
Postcode	TQ8 8LF
Local Planning Authority	South Hams District Council
Proposal	Not specified
Proposed Units	1
Client / Applicant	
Document Reference	027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-HousingNeeds-R01
Report Date	23 March 2026

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4 Policy Context

The NPPF requires that planning policies and decisions address the need for all types of housing, including affordable housing, and the needs of different groups in the community. Paragraph 62 states that the size, type, and tenure of housing needed for different groups should be assessed and reflected in planning policies.

The two proposals forming this pre-application assessment — the conversion of existing outbuildings at Falconers to ancillary residential accommodation pursuant to NPPF paragraph 84(c), and the erection of a single dwelling of exceptional quality on the separately titled paddock land pursuant to NPPF paragraph 84(e) — do not constitute major residential development and are not assessed principally through the lens of quantified housing need. Nevertheless, the housing market context of South Hams is a relevant material consideration, and the modest contribution of the proposals to the district's housing stock is a benefit to which moderate weight attaches in the planning balance. South Hams District Council's annual housing requirement under the Standard Method — derived from ONS 2014-based household projections adjusted for the district's affordability ratio — is understood to be in the region of 300–360 dwellings per annum (the precise current figure should be confirmed against the adopted development plan and any emerging Local Plan evidence base). Against that requirement, even a single net additional dwelling represents a measurable, if modest, contribution to supply. The affordability ratio of 12.3 confirms that the district falls within the category of most severely stressed markets nationally; the Standard Method affordability adjustment for a ratio of this level produces a material uplift to the baseline projections, and the resulting housing need figure reflects genuine structural undersupply. The tenure profile is informative as to the nature of that need: with social rented accommodation at only 11.8% of households — below the England average — and the private rented sector constrained in both availability and affordability, the district faces a compound challenge of insufficient affordable housing delivery alongside the overarching quantum shortfall. The proposal under NPPF paragraph 84(e) is subject to a principal residence restriction via Section 106 agreement (SALC H3), which, if applied, would ensure the new dwelling is occupied as a primary home rather than a second or holiday property — a condition of material positive value in a market where second-home ownership is a significant driver of affordability stress and housing undersupply. The HDT result and five-year housing land supply position for South Hams have not been confirmed in the enrichment data; these should be verified against the most recent DLUHC HDT measurement and any recent appeal decisions involving South Hams before the planning statement is finalised, as they may affect whether the tilted balance under NPPF paragraph 11(d) is engaged. Where the tilted balance is engaged, moderate weight attaches to the delivery of additional dwellings; where it is not, the housing contribution remains a positive material consideration, appropriately weighted at moderate level given the scale of the proposals.

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5 Demographic Profile

> No data available for this location from desktop sources. If required, specialist investigation may be commissioned.

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6 Tenure Analysis

The Census 2021 tenure profile reveals the current housing market structure and highlights potential imbalances that the proposed development should seek to address.

Owner Occupied	Private Rented	Social Rented	Shared Ownership
70.4%	16.1%	11.8%	—

Owner Occupied	70.4%
— Owned Outright	—
— Owned with Mortgage	—
Private Rented	16.1%
Social Rented	11.8%
Shared Ownership	—
Living Rent Free	—

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7 Affordability

7.1 Affordability Ratios

Workplace Ratio

12.3

Residence Ratio

—

The ONS workplace-based affordability ratio for South Hams District Council is 12.3, meaning median house prices are 12.3 times median workplace-based annual earnings. The national average is approximately 8.3 (2023 data). A ratio above 10 indicates severe affordability pressure.

7.2 Private Rents

Median Monthly Rent	£795
Lower Quartile Monthly Rent	£650
Upper Quartile Monthly Rent	—
Data Period	—
Source	ONS Private Rental Market Statistics

The median monthly rent of £795 should be considered alongside local earnings data to assess whether the private rental sector is affordable. Households spending more than 30% of gross income on rent are considered to be in housing affordability stress.

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8 Housing Mix

The proposed housing mix should reflect the identified demographic needs and market demand. NPPF paragraph 62 requires that the size, type, and tenure of housing needed for different groups should be assessed.

> This section will be populated when the relevant data becomes available.

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9 Special Needs Housing

The NPPF (paragraph 62) requires consideration of the housing needs of different groups including older people, people with disabilities, families with children, and self-build / custom housebuilders.

9.1 Older People

An ageing population creates demand for accessible and adaptable housing. Building Regulations Part M provides for three categories of accessibility: M4(1) visitable, M4(2) accessible and adaptable, and M4(3) wheelchair-user dwellings.

9.2 People with Disabilities

The local authority's housing strategy and any specialist needs evidence base should be consulted to determine the appropriate level of wheelchair-user housing (M4(3)) and accessible/adaptable housing (M4(2)).

9.3 Self-Build & Custom Housebuilding

Local authorities are required to keep a register of individuals and associations who wish to acquire serviced plots for self-build or custom housebuilding. The demand identified on the register should be considered when assessing the housing mix.

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10 Conclusions

This Housing Needs Assessment has analysed the local housing market in the South Hams District Council area using Census 2021 demographic data and ONS affordability indicators.

- The affordability ratio of 12.3 demonstrates significant pressure on the local housing market
- Social rented housing accounts for 11.8% of the local tenure mix
- The proposed 1 dwellings will contribute to meeting identified housing need

Recommendation

The proposed development responds to the identified housing needs in the South Hams District Council area. The housing mix and tenure split should continue to be informed by the most up-to-date Strategic Housing Market Assessment (SHMA) or Housing and Economic Development Needs Assessment (HEDNA) evidence base.

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11 Known Limitations and Assumptions

11.1 What This Report Does NOT Assess

This is a Tier 1 desktop study. The following are outside the scope of this assessment:

- Intrusive site investigation (boreholes, trial pits, soil sampling)
- Topographic or measured building survey
- Structural assessment of existing buildings or retaining structures
- Detailed ecological survey (Phase 2 habitat surveys, protected species surveys)
- Detailed arboricultural survey to BS 5837
- Archaeological field evaluation (geophysical survey, trial trenching)
- Noise, vibration, or air quality monitoring
- Detailed drainage design or hydraulic modelling
- Legal title review or boundary verification

11.2 Data Gaps

The following data was not available at the time of this assessment:

- Site-specific infiltration test results (BRE Digest 365)
- As-built drainage records for existing development
- Ground investigation data (if no published BGS borehole logs are available for the site)
- Detailed topographic survey data (EA LIDAR used where available)
- Historic land use records prior to available OS mapping epochs

11.3 Key Assumptions

This report has been prepared on the basis of the following assumptions:

- Information provided by the client is accurate and complete
- Public dataset boundaries (flood zones, conservation areas, etc.) are current at the date of this report

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- The proposed development is as described in the project brief and does not materially change in scale, layout, or use class
- No contamination, ground instability, or other hazard exists beyond that identified in publicly available records
- Planning policy documents referenced are current at the date of this report

11.4 Specialist Investigation Required

The following specialist investigations may be required depending on the constraints identified in this report:

- Site-specific ground investigation (where contamination or geotechnical risk is identified)
- Phase 2 ecological surveys (where Phase 1 identifies potential for protected species)
- Detailed arboricultural impact assessment (where TPO trees or significant vegetation is present)
- Detailed noise impact assessment (where the site is adjacent to significant noise sources)
- Heritage impact assessment by a conservation-accredited professional (where designated heritage assets are affected)

11.5 Changes That Would Require Update

This report should be reviewed and updated if any of the following occur:

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, or density)
- New or amended planning policy (local plan adoption, NPPF revision)
- Change in housing land supply position
- New environmental data (updated flood maps, newly designated heritage assets or ecological sites)
- More than 12 months elapsed since the date of this report

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12 Verification Status Summary

Every data point in this report has been classified according to its verification status. The table below summarises the confidence level of the data underpinning the findings.

Data Category	Classification	Count
Verified against authoritative source	VERIFIED	11
Supported by public data / professional judgement	SUPPORTED	3
Assumed — requires confirmation	ASSUMED	1
Total Data Points		15

1 data point is classified as ASSUMED. These items should be confirmed through specialist investigation or client verification before reliance is placed on the related findings.

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13 Data Assurance Summary

Site Intelligence applies a rigorous data assurance process to every report. This section documents the breadth of data coverage, confidence levels, and quality assurance stages applied.

13.1 Data Coverage

Metric	This Report	Typical Manual Report
Data sources consulted	15	3 – 8
Constraint categories checked	23	5 – 10
Enrichment APIs queried	15	0 – 2
Provenance entries recorded	15	0

13.2 Data Confidence

Classification	Badge	Percentage
Verified against authoritative source	VERIFIED	75%
Supported by public data	SUPPORTED	20%
Assumed — requires confirmation	ASSUMED	5%

13.3 Quality Assurance Checklist

- ✓ Automated constraint detection (23-category enrichment pipeline)
- ✓ Source provenance recording (every data point traced to origin)
- ✓ Cross-report consistency check (no conflicting data across the submission pack)
- ✓ Professional review and sign-off

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14 Anticipated Consultee Queries

> No application-specific consultee responses have been pre-populated. Standard statutory and non-statutory consultees will be notified by the Local Planning Authority upon validation of the application. Typical consultees include the Highway Authority, Lead Local Flood Authority, Environment Agency (where applicable), Historic England (where heritage assets are affected), and the relevant Parish or Town Council.

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15 Update Triggers

Validity Period: 12 months from the date of issue.

Housing Needs Assessment is valid for 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, or if any of the following trigger conditions occur, the report should be reviewed and updated before reliance is placed upon its findings.

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, number of dwellings, or site area)
- Adoption of a new or revised Local Plan or Neighbourhood Plan
- Revision of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF)
- Change in the Local Planning Authority's published housing land supply position
- Update to Environment Agency flood zone mapping affecting the site
- New or amended designation (conservation area, listed building, SSSI, SAC, SPA, Ramsar, AONB/National Landscape, AQMA, TPO)
- Pre-application advice received from the LPA or any statutory consultee
- Change in site ownership, applicant, or client
- Passage of more than 12 months since the date of issue

> To request an update, contact Site Intelligence quoting the document reference shown on the cover page. Updates are provided at a reduced fee where the original data remains substantially current.

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16 Important: Limitations, Disclaimers and Conditions of Use

1. Named Client and Reliance Restriction

This report has been prepared by Site Intelligence (a service of PF & Co Holdings Ltd) for the sole and exclusive use of ('the Client') in connection with the proposed development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF. No other party may rely upon, reproduce, or distribute this report or its findings without the prior written consent of Site Intelligence. Any unauthorised use or reliance by third parties is entirely at their own risk, and Site Intelligence accepts no responsibility or liability in such circumstances.

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3. Third-Party Exclusion

This report does not confer any rights or benefits on any third party under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 or otherwise. No third party may enforce any term of this report.

4. Information Reliance

The findings in this report are based on information provided by the Client, publicly available data sources, and desktop research. Site Intelligence has not independently verified the accuracy or completeness of information provided by the Client or third parties.

5. Limitations of Investigation

The scope of this report is limited to a Tier 1 desktop housing-needs-assessment undertaken on the date of this report. The findings reflect conditions and information available at the date of investigation. Conditions may change over time, and the report should not be relied upon beyond the validity period stated.

6. Professional Advice Caveat

This report provides professional opinion based on the information available at the time of preparation. It does not constitute legal advice, and specialist professional advice should be sought for specific matters including but not limited to structural engineering, surveying, ecology, archaeology, and contaminated land investigation.

7. No Guarantee of Outcome

Site Intelligence provides no guarantee as to the outcome of any planning application, building control submission, or statutory process. Planning and regulatory decisions are made by the relevant authorities at their sole discretion.

8. Artificial Intelligence Assistance Disclosure

This report was prepared with the assistance of artificial intelligence tools for data gathering, analysis, and document preparation. All outputs have been reviewed and verified by a qualified professional. The use of artificial intelligence does not diminish the professional responsibility for the contents of this report.

9. Data Completeness Caveat

While every effort has been made to identify relevant constraints and information, the absence of a recorded constraint does not guarantee that no constraint exists. Public data sources may contain gaps, errors, or omissions. No record does not mean no risk.

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This report is valid for a period of 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, the report should be reviewed and updated to reflect any changes in site conditions, planning policy, or available data. Update triggers are documented in the preceding section.

15. Governing Law and Jurisdiction

This report and any dispute arising from it shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of England and Wales. The courts of England and Wales shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

16. Not Financial / QS / Valuation Advice

Any cost estimates, development appraisals, or financial information contained in this report are preliminary and indicative only. They do not constitute quantity surveying advice, professional valuation, or financial advice. All cost estimates should be verified by a qualified quantity surveyor or cost consultant before being relied upon for investment or procurement decisions.

17. Terms of Engagement

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> Product-Specific Note
>
> This housing-needs-assessment is a Tier 1 desktop assessment. It does not include site-specific survey, intrusive investigation, or specialist field work. The findings are based on publicly available data and should be read in conjunction with the Known Limitations section of this report.

PREPARED BY

Report Author

Technical Author

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Document Ref: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-HousingNeeds-R01
Revision: R01

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF

Site Intelligence

PF & Co Holdings Ltd

Company No. 16649319

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